

Chapter 44-1

Returning to her hotel room, Yin Lingzhu took deep breaths of air.

Just now on the film set, facing Yan Si's such direct gaze, the disgust in her heart wasn't as strong as before.

She actually found Yan Si's sneaky watching amusing, like a kitten that had done something wrong.

Not daring to look at its owner openly, thinking its stealthy glances were very careful, but in reality, its actions were quite obvious.

Yin Lingzhu noticed her inner thoughts and wasn't even very surprised.

These past few days, she had seen what Yan Si had done. Regardless of Yan Si's reasons, saying she wasn't shocked in her heart would be a lie.

Yin Lingzhu looked through the window with a distant gaze at the sky outside.

At the far horizon, a red color slightly lighter than blood spread beneath the blue sky.

Yin Lingzhu watched the sunset, slowly calming her emotions.

She and Yan Si had no future.

They were originally people from two different worlds, in every sense.

Thinking this way, Yin Lingzhu inexplicably smiled.

Why think so much? Right now, filling her stomach was more important.

Yin Lingzhu put aside her earlier worries and began thinking about nearby places to eat.

With her current funds, Yin Lingzhu finally chose a spicy hot pot¹ shop.

Very cheap.

She wasn't an idol now, so there was no need to be so strict with herself, constantly calculating food calories and having so many dietary restrictions.

Although most people thought spicy hot pot was unhealthy, it couldn't be helped that it was delicious.

Yin Lingzhu thought optimistically, even her walking pace becoming cheerful.

In the shop.

Yin Lingzhu frantically shook the vegetables in her hand, trying to shake off the water.

When weighing, it could cost a little less money.

Since it was evening now, the dinner rush hour.

The shop was almost full of people.

Yin Lingzhu spotted a table and immediately claimed it after the people finished eating.

This was the kind of observation skills needed when eating at small shops.

Yin Lingzhu thought happily.

But her good mood didn't last three seconds before she saw the shop's door curtain move.

Someone walked in who completely didn't match the atmosphere of the small shop.

After Yan Si selected her food, she seemingly casually chose a seat that happened to be at Yin Lingzhu's table.

Generally in small shops, if a table only had one person, others could sit in the remaining seats.

But in this socially anxious society, most people wouldn't choose to sit with a stranger.

Therefore, Yan Si sitting in this position was indeed not problematic.

It was already autumn, yet Yan Si was still wearing a skirt.

A black velvet dress, exposing her fair arms. Thin high heels clicked on the ground with crisp, tiny sounds, highlighting her beautiful instep.

Yan Si's hair was pinned up, looking very gentle.

She wore a mask on her face and sat across from Yin Lingzhu.

Their table was positioned rather remotely, in a corner of the room.

After Yan Si sat down, everyone could only see her back and couldn't see her face.

Yin Lingzhu's food was ready at this time. She buried her head and focused on eating.

Trying to use the deliciousness of food to forget everything.

She didn't even look at her phone, which was usually essential during meals.

She just wanted to finish eating quickly and leave this place immediately.

Just as Yin Lingzhu was eating with her head down, she suddenly felt another person sit in front of her.

Yin Lingzhu instinctively looked up.

Ming Qingyun sat beside Yan Si, smiling at her.

These two, one wearing a long dress, one wearing a suit.

Everything about them screamed "rich."

They looked like they belonged in five-star restaurants costing thousands per person, not this little stall costing a few yuan or dozens of yuan per person.

The people around also noticed the two out-of-place individuals, frantically directing their gazes toward this table.

Yan Si and Ming Qingyun were fine since they had their backs to everyone and couldn't notice their stares.

But Yin Lingzhu wasn't - she directly received everyone's gaze.

Like looking at monkeys.

Yin Lingzhu thought, feeling extremely embarrassed.

To cover her embarrassment, Yin Lingzhu greeted Ming Qingyun.

"You're here to eat too?"

After saying this, Yin Lingzhu wanted to cover her face. What kind of thing had she just said?

They had already come here and sat down.

If they weren't here to eat, what else would they be doing?

Ming Qingyun seemed not to notice the stupidity of the question and smiled as she answered.

"Yes, I come to this shop often. It's very delicious."

After discussing which nearby restaurants were good for a few sentences, Yan Si and Ming Qingyun's food also arrived.

At other tables with two or more people, everyone was chatting enthusiastically.

Only at their table.

Silent as chickens.

Yin Lingzhu used the fastest speed of her life, finishing her meal in two or three bites.

After saying goodbye to Ming Qingyun, Yin Lingzhu left the small shop and took a big breath of fresh air.

Just now in the restaurant, she seemed to be able to smell what awkwardness felt like.

After Yin Lingzhu left, Yan Si and Ming Qingyun simultaneously put down their chopsticks.

If Yin Lingzhu hadn't eaten so hastily just now and had paid a little attention, she would have discovered that Yan Si and Ming Qingyun had barely eaten anything.

Ming Qingyun looked at Yan Si with a smug smile.

"It seems Lingzhu doesn't think much of you now."

Ming Qingyun's suit was straight, but her words weren't so proper, carrying some schadenfreude.

Yan Si replied bluntly, "I'm her wife. We just had a small conflict."

"But what about you? Your behavior is interfering in someone else's marriage. CEO Ming wouldn't want to be a homewrecker, would you?"

Yan Si's expression was calm, but her words were like knives, stabbing directly at people's hearts.

Ming Qingyun acted as if she'd heard some funny joke. "Haha, Lingzhu would rather use suppressants during her heat cycle than be with you. You're really a competent wife."

"But I didn't expect Lingzhu to actually be S-level. I remember she was B-level in university."

Ming Qingyun was equally picking hurtful things to say.

Both sides' words simultaneously hit their soft spots.

Yan Si looked at Ming Qingyun. Even though Yan Si had styled her hair gently, it didn't diminish her assertiveness.

Just now Ming Qingyun's tone carried intimacy, especially when mentioning university, her face showed nostalgia.

This made Yan Si very displeased.

"CEO Ming, I'll say it again - don't be a homewrecker." Yan Si's face was full of mockery.

But Ming Qingyun didn't take her threats seriously.

"I wonder if you've heard this saying." Ming Qingyun smiled.

"In love, the one who isn't loved is the real mistress."

Ming Qingyun's words were very clear, with a shameless spirit.

"Recently Ming Group seems to be expanding. If at this time, the companies cooperating with it had problems, what would the consequences be?"

Yan Si's gaze didn't back down, her meaning clear.

Yan Si's company was currently in a leading position, unshakeable.

But Ming Qingyun's wasn't necessarily so.

Footnotes:

¹ Spicy hot pot (麻辣燙): A popular Chinese street food where customers select raw ingredients that are then cooked in spicy broth. It's typically very affordable and casual dining.